Go To Bed

By Andy Griffiths

NOTE: *Items in ( ) should be presented as an aside to the audience . . .*

(Pg 35-52) I'm lying on the couch
reading a book ***(It's really cool. It's about this kid who won't go to bed)***
When Mom comes in
and gives me THAT look ***(You know the one)***

"Andy?" she says,
"Did you hear what I said?
Put down that book and GO TO BED!"

But there's no way
I'm going to bed. ***(I bet the X-Men don't go to bed at 8:30)***
It's time to stall.
It's time to beg.

INTRODUCTION

Bedtime is supposed to be calm and peaceful . . . but clearly no one told Andy. Join me on a rollicking adventure that begins as an innocent moment on the couch but explodes into a full-scale bedtime war. You'll witness desperate negotiations, mysterious illnesses, ghost infestations, legal threats, and a highly dramatic countdown to doom. Now let the show begin!

Go to Bed by Andy Griffiths

4NG Fanatics

"Can't I say up for
just half an hour more?"
"No!" says Mom,
and she points at the door. ***(She thinks that just because she points at the door, I'm going to go through it. Boy, is she in for a surprise)***

"Twenty minutes? Ten minutes?
Five minutes? One? ***(I've already gained at least a minute, anyway, so I'm already winning, no matter what she says.)***
Please can I stay up?
Please can I, Mom?"

"Come on," she says,
"Mom knows best.
If you weren't so tired,
you wouldn't protest. ***(Mom's argument makes no sense. Because if I argue, it proves, according to her, that I'm tired and I need to go to bed. But if I don't argue, I end up having to go to bed, anyway. What does she think I am? An idiot?)***

"You've had a good time.
You've had a big day.
Just be a good boy

EDUCATIONAL USE ONLY

and do what I say."
I stomp my foot
and shake my head.
"I am NOT a good boy.
I will NOT go to bed!" ***(There's no way I'm going to give in. Especially since Dad's not home)***

But then the door opens
and in walks Dad. ***(Uh-oh)***
He's got a big frown.
He looks mad.

"Not in bed yet,
Andy?" say he.
"I'll give you to
the count of three!" ***(Dad always counts to three. I think that's because it's as high as he can count.)***

"One," he says.
He stares at me . . .
"Two," he says.
He pauses . . . "THREE!" ***(The thing is, when he says "three" he's not kidding around anymore. Better do what he says)***

I leave the room.
I count to ten . . . *[Count to ten]*
And then I go
back in again. ***(You didn't really think I was going to give up that easily, did you?)***

4NG Fanatics

"I've lost my pajamas!
I can't find my teddy! ***(I'm just making this up, of course. As if I still need a teddy bear – they're just for babies)***
I'm hungry! I'm thirsty!
I'm really not ready!"
But Mom and Dad
ignore what I said.
"ANDY," they say,
"JUST GO TO BED!" ***(Okay, they asked for it . . .)***

"But I've got a sore finger
and I've got a sore butt.
I've got pains in my legs
and my arm has a cut . . . ***(None of this is true – I'm actually 100 percent healthy, but they don't know that)***

"Not to mention my lice
and my chronic back pain
My cloudy vision!
My aching brain!

"My teeth! My tongue!
My eyes! My nose!
My tonsils! My kidneys!
My stomach! My toes! ***(Actually, the more I think about it, the worse I feel)***

"I can't go to sleep.

FOR EDUCATIONAL USE ONLY

I'll wake up dead!"
"You soon will be," says Dad,
"if you DON'T go to bed!" ***(Did I hear right? Did my dad just give me a death threat?)***

I start to cry. ***(Not real crying. Just pretend)***
I start to moan.
"How would YOU like it
up there all alone?

"How would you like it
in your lumpy old bed
with the lumps in your pillow
sticking into your head?

"How would you like it
if your pajamas were too tight
and you had to lie there
with a wedgie all night?" ***(I've had these X-Men pajamas since I was four. I've asked Mom for new ones, but she says they don't make them in my size – that they only make them for little kids. I think she's just trying to save money)***

Now Dad's really mad.
He's pretty near blowing.
"All right," I say,
"I'm going! I'm going!"

I climb the stairs

4NG Fanatics

toward my room.
I open the door ***(With difficulty. There's a huge pile of clothes on the floor)***
and face my doom.

I'm all alone.
I'm full of fear.
It's cold and dark
and ghosts live here! ***(The ghosts live in my closet. That's why my clothes are all over the floor. I'm too scared to open it and put them away.)***

A thumping noise!
A spooky sound!
I turn around
and run back down. ***(I want my mommy!)***

Mom looks at me.
Dad shakes his head. ***(My mom and dad shake their heads a lot. Especially around bedtime)***
"I thought we told you to
GO TO BED!"

"But I'm scared," I cry,
"I heard a thump.
It came from the closet.
Something went bump!" ***(It wasn't the Boogeyman either. He lives under my bed)***

"Don't make me go back there!

FOR EDUCATIONAL USE ONLY

Don't make me stay!
It's cruelty to kids!
I'll tell the SPCA!" ***(Society for the Prevention of Cruelty to Andys)***

But Mom and Dad
Don't seem too scared. ***(Probably because they've heard this one before)***
"WE DON'T CARE," they shout,
"JUST GO TO BED!"

It's not looking good.
They're tough nuts to crack.
But I WILL win.
I'm NOT going back,

I'm going to give it
one last try.
It's time to pull out
My ultimate lie . . .

"But I CAN'T go to bed,"
I say to those two.
"I can't go now,
I've got homework to do!" ***(Well, actually, it's not a lie. I do have homework, but I have no intention of actually doing it.)***

"It's too late now,"
says my dad.

4NG Fanatics

"Yes," says Mom,
"it's just too bad!" ***(They obviously need a little more persuasion. Well, here it comes . . .)***

"But if I don't do it
I'm doomed!" I wail.
"If it's not in tomorrow
I'm going to fail!" ***(Mom and Dad hate it when I say the F-word)***

"I'll be expelled!
I'll be out on the street
Who knows what thugs
I'm likely to meet?"

"I'll join a gang!
I'll commit a crime!" ***(Not just walking when the sign says DON'T WALK, either. I mean a really bad crime. Like running across the road without even looking. And going to bed without brushing my teeth. And writing rap songs with lots of swears in them.)***
I'll end up behind bars
doing time!

"But there isn't a jail
that could ever hold me.
I'd have to break out!
I'd have to bust free!

"Every cop in the world

FOR EDUCATIONAL USE ONLY

would be looking for me.
A fugitive
is what I'd be. ***(They'll probably make a movie about me and everything)***

"Hunted like an animal.
Public Enemy Number One!
Is that what you want
for your favorite son?"

I pause and wait
for my words to sink in***. (They look kind of stunned)***
Have I convinced them?
Will I win?

"All right," says Dad.
"Perhaps we were wrong.
Stay up if you have to.
Stay up all night long. ***(Hmmmm. This could be a trick)***

"Just do your homework
Just get it all done.
We don't want you living
a life on the run." ***(No, I don't think it's a trick. They've swallowed my story hook, line and sinker.)***

I look at my dad.
I look at my mom.
I can't believe
they've bought this one.

4NG Fanatics

This is amazing!
This is great!
I got what I wanted!
I'm staying up late!

But then Mom and Dad
get up out of their chairs,
walk out of the room,
And start climbing the stairs. ***(Huh?)***

"Hey, where are you going?"
I say, scratching my head.
"We're tired," says Mom.
"We're going to bed." ***(She does look tired, actually. So does Dad. It must be awful being that ancient)***

"But what about me,"
I say, "here all alone?
I'll be all by myself!
I'll be all on my own! ***(Parents can be SO selfish.)***

"You CAN'T go to bed!
Not at THIS time of night!
You're older than me! ***(It doesn't make sense. The whole point of being a grown-up is that you don't have to go to bed early.)***
It just isn't right!"

But Dad just yawns

FOR EDUCATIONAL USE ONLY

and says, “Good night.
Don’t forget to lock up
and switch off the light.” ***(This has never happened before. Never!)***

“Hey, wait!” I say,
but they’ve disappeared.
I don’t like this --
it feels kind of weird. ***(I mean, what’s their problem. Don’t they LIKE spending time with me?)***

I’m all alone.
I’m full of fear.
I sit on the couch.
I don’t like it here. ***(Not anymore)***

What was that noise?
I heard something squeak. ***(No, it didn’t come from me. Or my butt)***
Something went bump!
Something went creak!

It could be a mouse . . .
but it might be a bat! ***(A vampire bat that came to suck on my blood. Aaggggghhhh!)***
No, I’m just being silly,
it’s probably the cat.

But what am I thinking?
I let out a shout:

4NG Fanatics

“WE DON’T HAVE A CAT!”
This is creeping me out!

I try to calm down.
I turn on the TV.
But the first thing I see
is a horror movie. ***(Normally, I love horror movies, but it’s not what I need right now)***

The living room
fills with horrible shrieks!
It’s a film about ax-wielding
blood-sucking freaks.

I get up from the couch
Like a rocket I zoom –
I shoot up the stairs
and into my room!

Before I know it
I’m cozy and calm
with my favorite old teddy
snuggled under my arm. ***(All right, I admit it. I DO have a teddy bear. In fact, I have a few. And I like to cuddle them in bed. So what? I bet you would too if you had ghosts in your closet)***

I pull the blanket up to my chin.
“I’m safe and I’m warm
And I’m all tucked in. ***(Sure, I know I didn’t want to go***

FOR EDUCATIONAL USE ONLY

4NG Fanatics

to bed before, but I've changed my mind, okay?)

Yes . . . I know I'm in bed.
But just you wait . . .
Tomorrow I'll stay up
REALLY late! ***(Good night)***

SOURCE INFORMATION

Author: Andy Griffiths
Book: Just Disgusting!, Pgs 35-52
ISBN: 978-0439549547
Publisher: Scholastic, Inc.
Date (Month/Year): Feb 2005

AWARD HISTORY

2019 National Qualifier – MS
2024 National Qualifier – MS
CO State Qualifier
KS State Qualifier

FOR EDUCATIONAL USE ONLY